that he is glad that he is neither a sportsman nor an athlete. Children have different (ii)_____ and wish to play various games. Each child has in mind something in particular, but the narrator is (iii)_____ he is not one of the players. Though the narrator (iv) _____ the talents of all athletes, he derives satisfaction from watching them, but does not wish to (v) _____ places with them. He also sometimes regrets that (vi)_____ athletes play rough games without caring for the feelings of their sporting rivals. He feels that good sense and caution win over ego. The narrator wholeheartedly offers (vii) _____ the modest (viii) _____ of athletes. Ultimately the narrator is (ix)_____ that he himself is not an athlete.

thanksgiving	exchange	glad
confesses	physiques	zealous
satisfied	aims	admires

3. Read the poem and answer the following in a short paragraph of 8–10 sentences each.

a. How does the poet establish the victory of common sense over ego?

b. The poet does not wish to exchange places with the athletes. How does he justify his view?

c. According to the poet what contributes most to the injuries sustained by the athletes?

4. Read the given lines and answer the questions that follow in a sentence or two.

a. *With all my heart I do admire*
Athletes who sweat for fun or hire

i. Whom does the poet admire?

ii. For what reasons do the athletes sweat?

b. *Well, ego it might be pleased enough*
But zealous athletes play so rough…

i. What pleases the ego?

ii. Why are athletes often rough during play?

c. *When officialdom demands,*
Is there a doctor in the stands?

i. Why are doctors called from stands by the sponsors?

ii. Why does the poet make such an observation?

d. *When snaps the knee and cracks the wrist….*

Identify and explain the use of the literary device in this line.

5. A. Explain the following with reference to the context in about 50–60 words each.

(i) I am just glad as glad can be
That I am not them, that they are not me…

(ii) They do not ever in their dealings
Consider one another's feelings…

(iii) Athletes, I'll drink to you,
Or eat with you,
Or anything except compete with you…

B. Underline the alliterated words in the following lines.

(i) My soul in true thanksgiving speaks

(ii) They do not ever in their dealings…

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